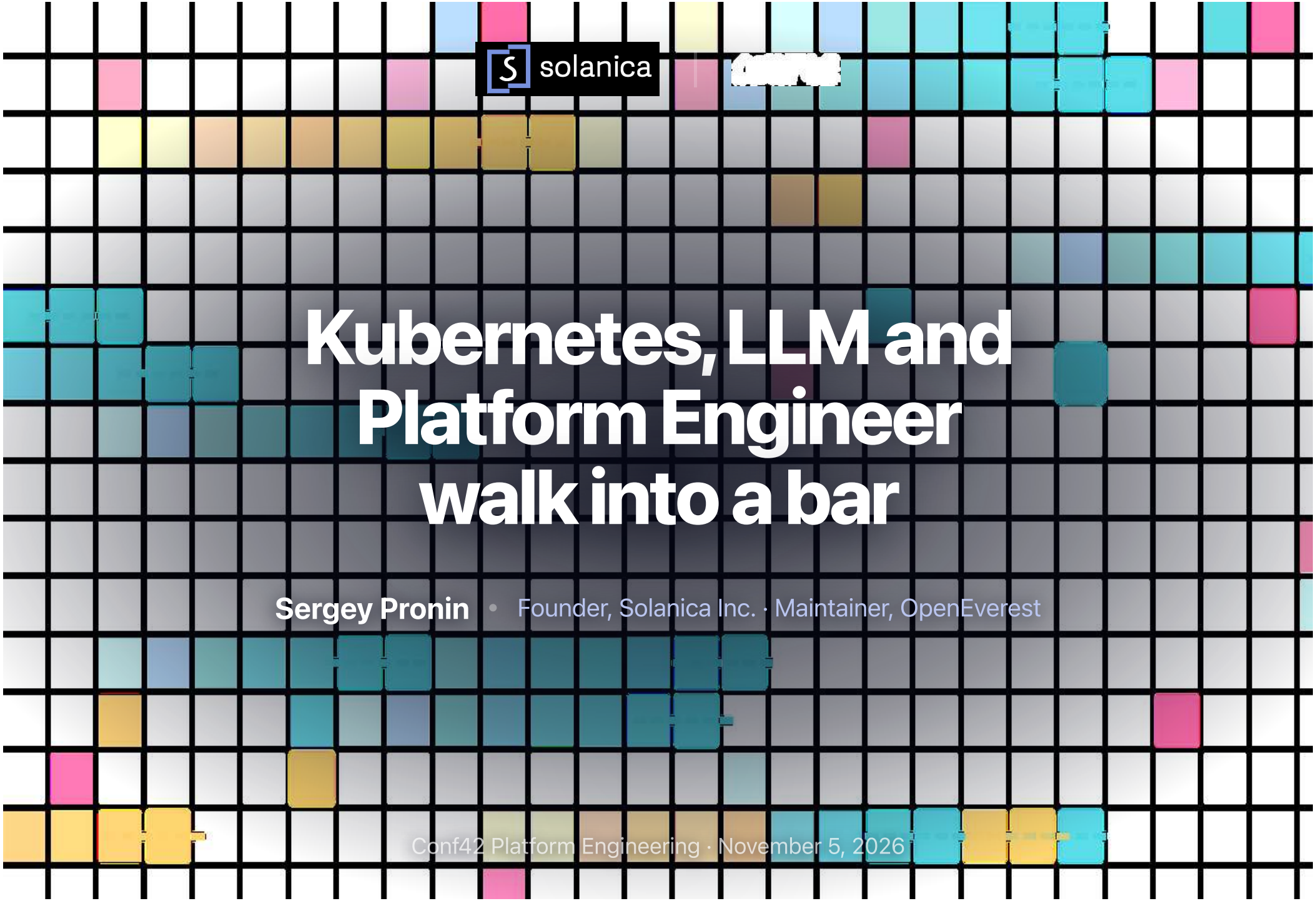
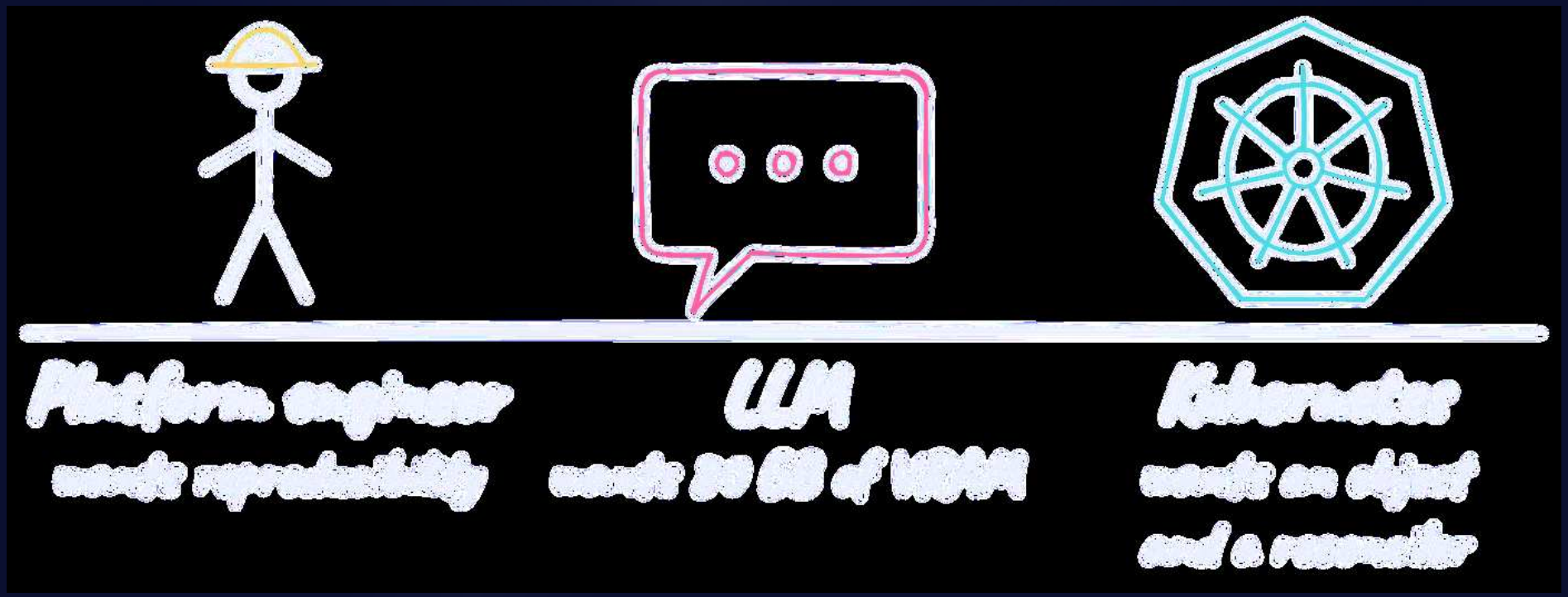

solanica
Kubernetes, LLM and Platform Engineer walk into a bar
Sergey Pronin • Founder, Solanica Inc. · Maintainer, OpenEverest
Conf42 Platform Engineering · November 5, 2026

Three walk into a bar



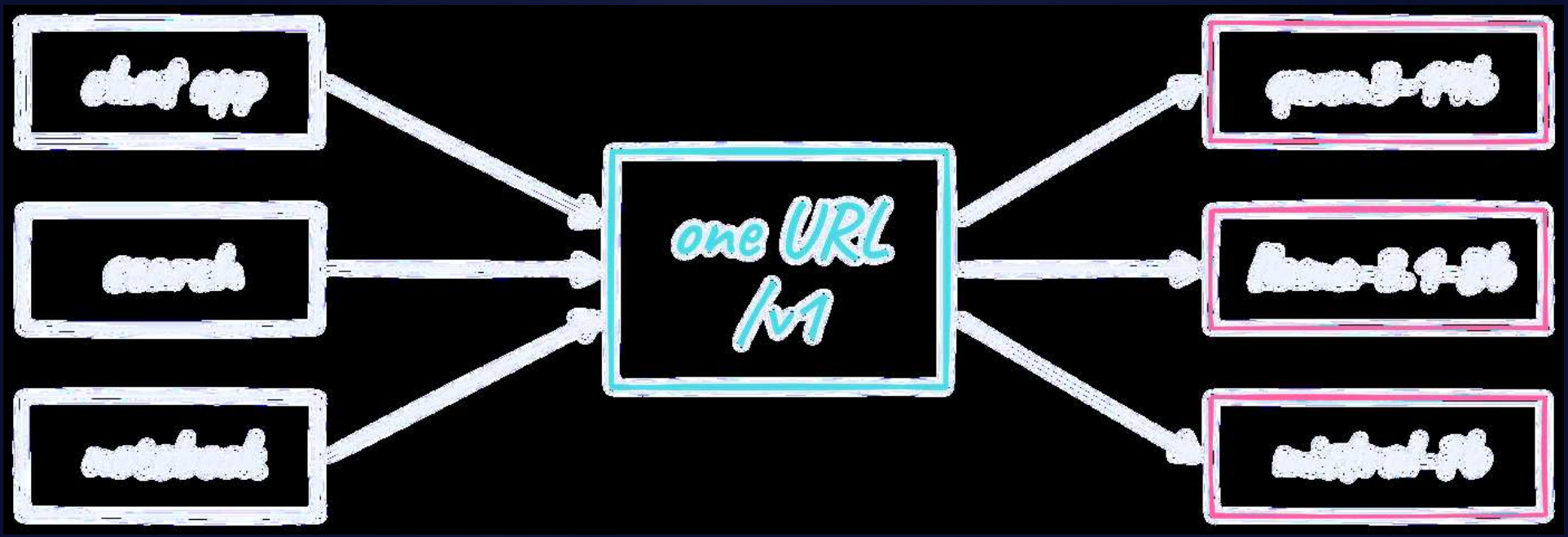
Then the ticket arrives



Why not just call an API?



What we're building

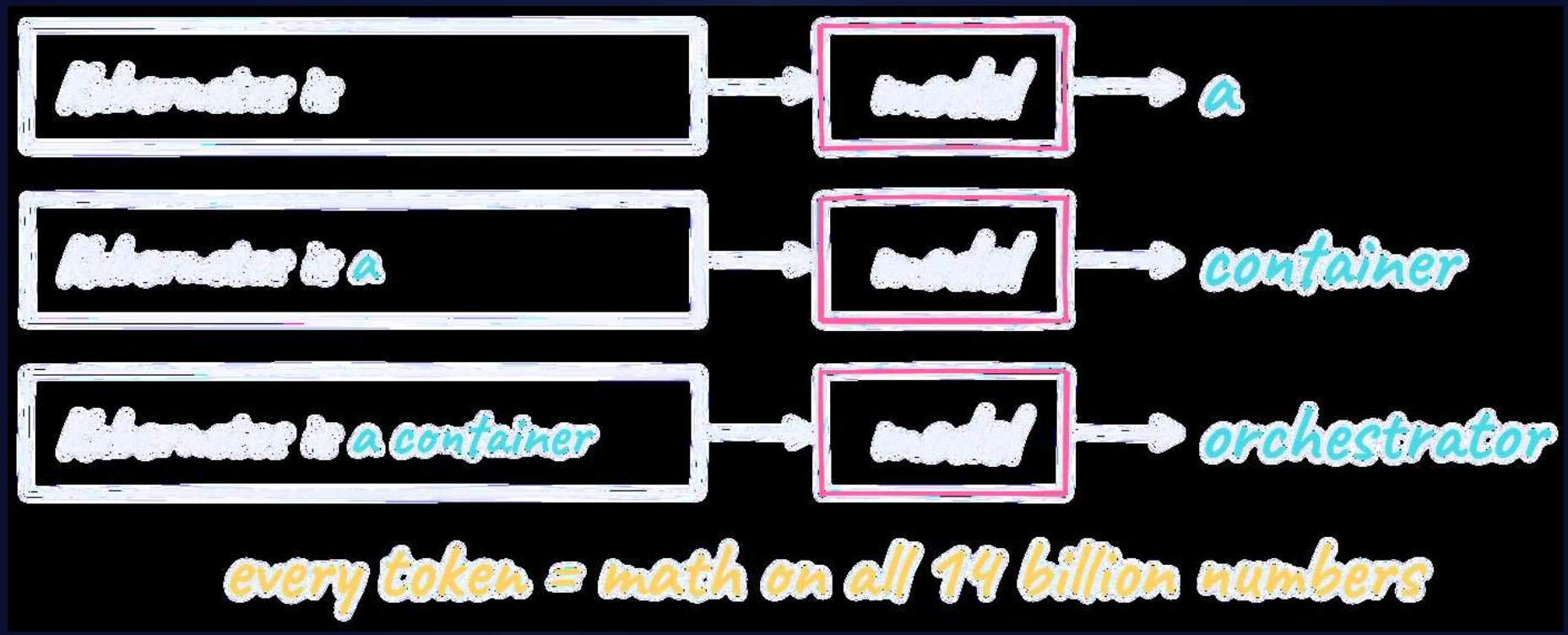



Day 1
What is a model anyway?

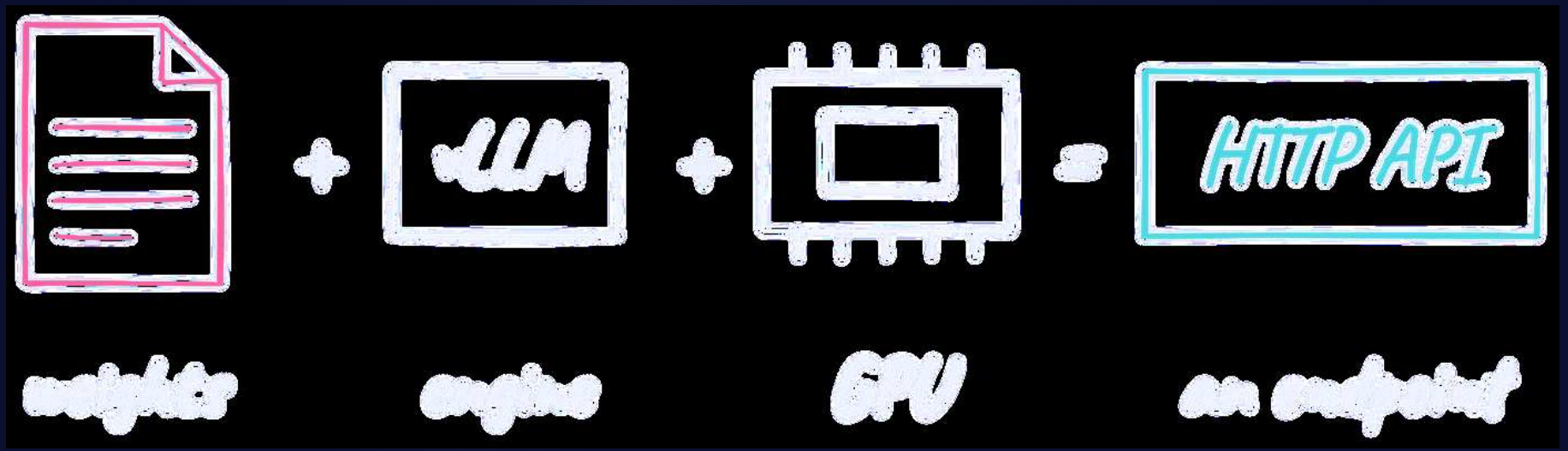
A model is just files



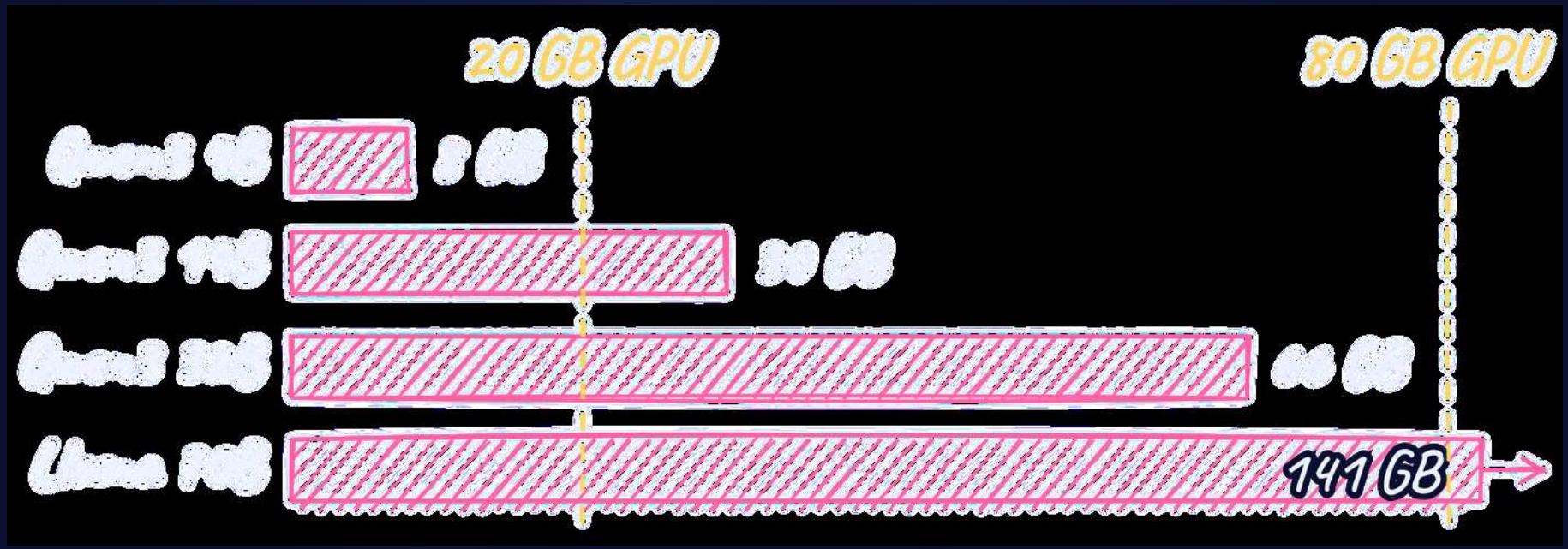
It writes one token at a time



Serving a model



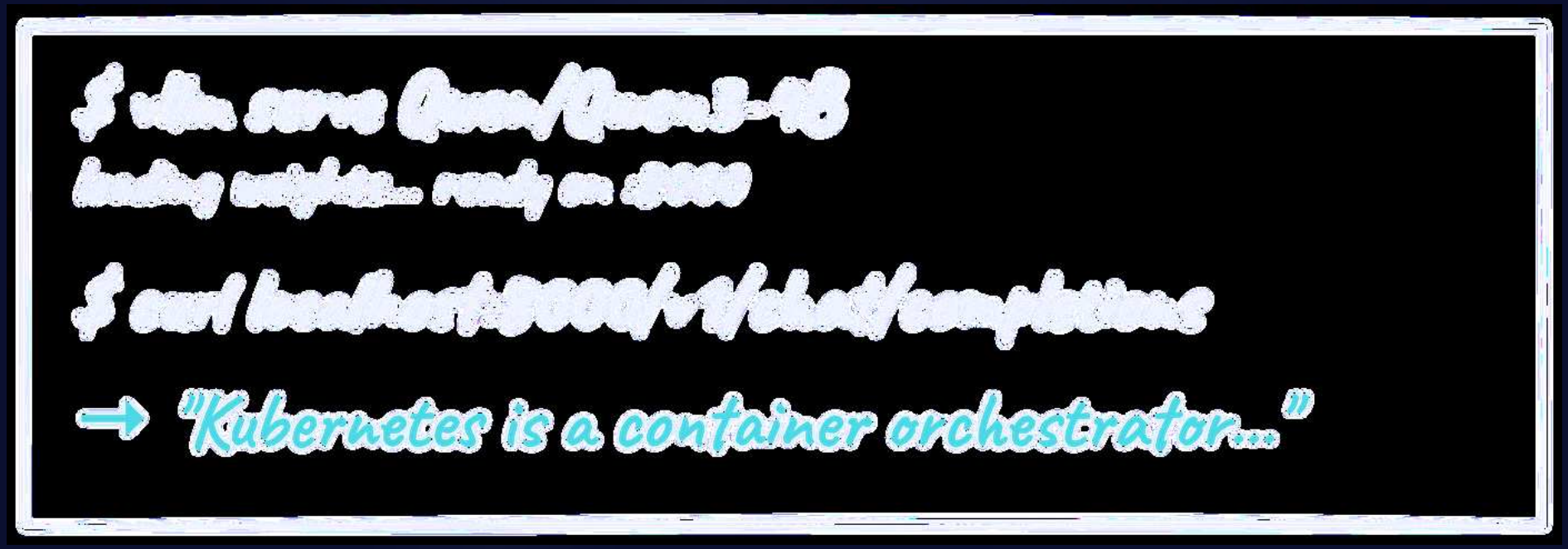
14B parameters ≈ 30 GB



What fills the GPU

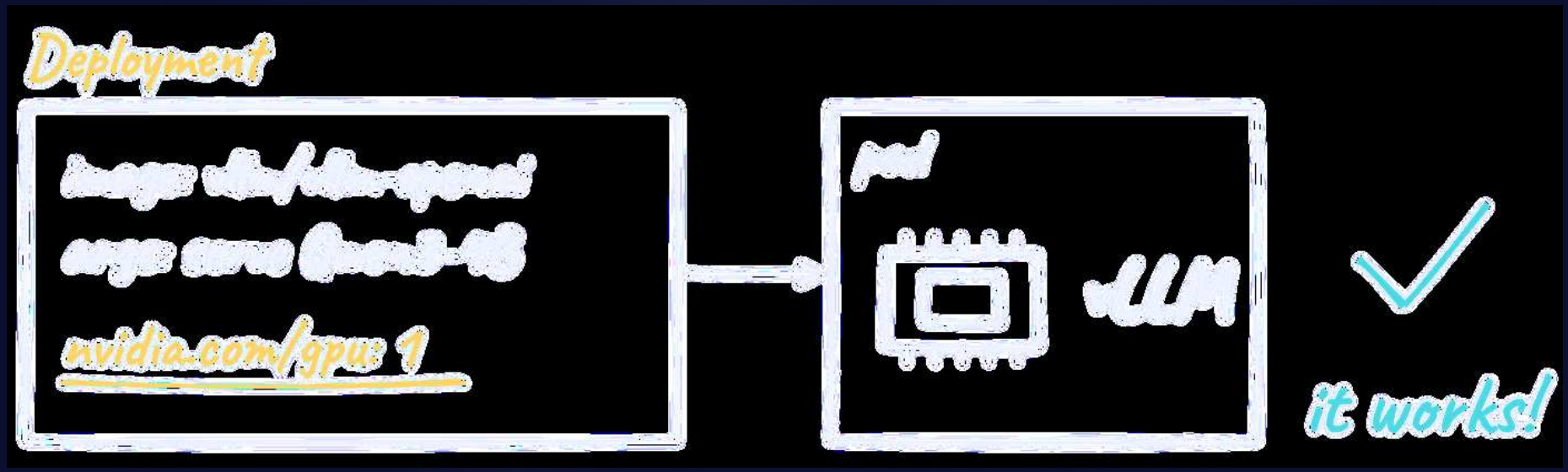


On one machine, it's one command




Week 1
Put it on Kubernetes

The naive way



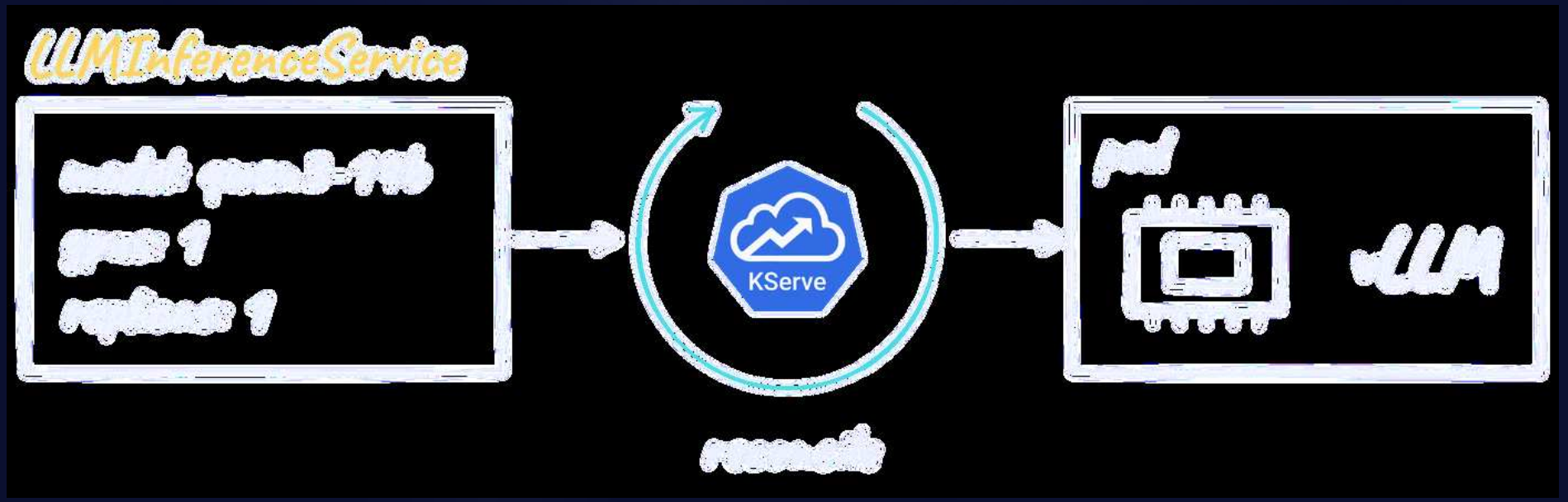
Then day 2 happens

- ~~every request downloads the model again~~
- ~~every model update = bandwidth bill~~
- ~~every model needs its own Lambda~~
- ~~two hours from expiry of this URL~~



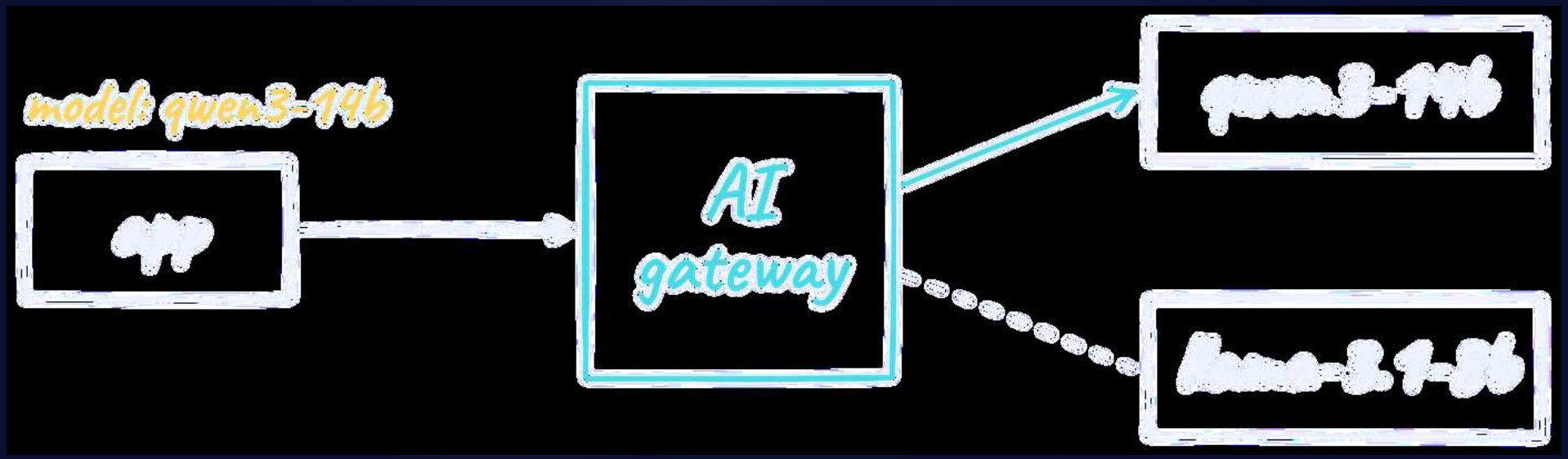
sound familiar?

An operator for models

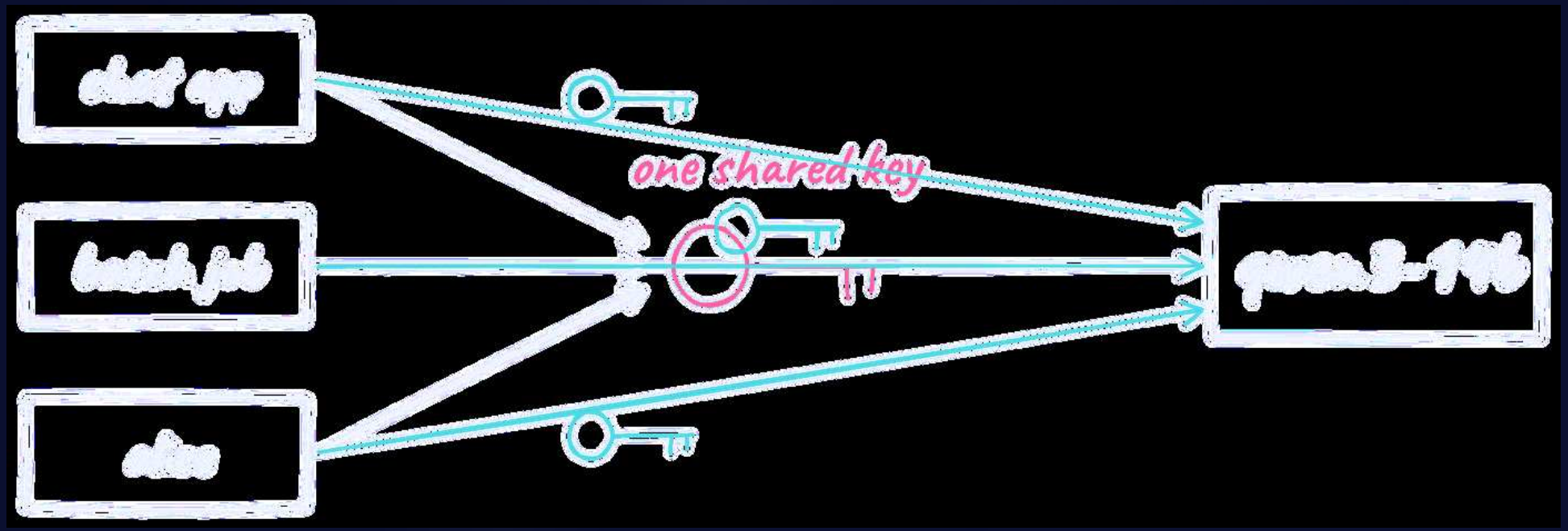



Week 3
The other teams find out

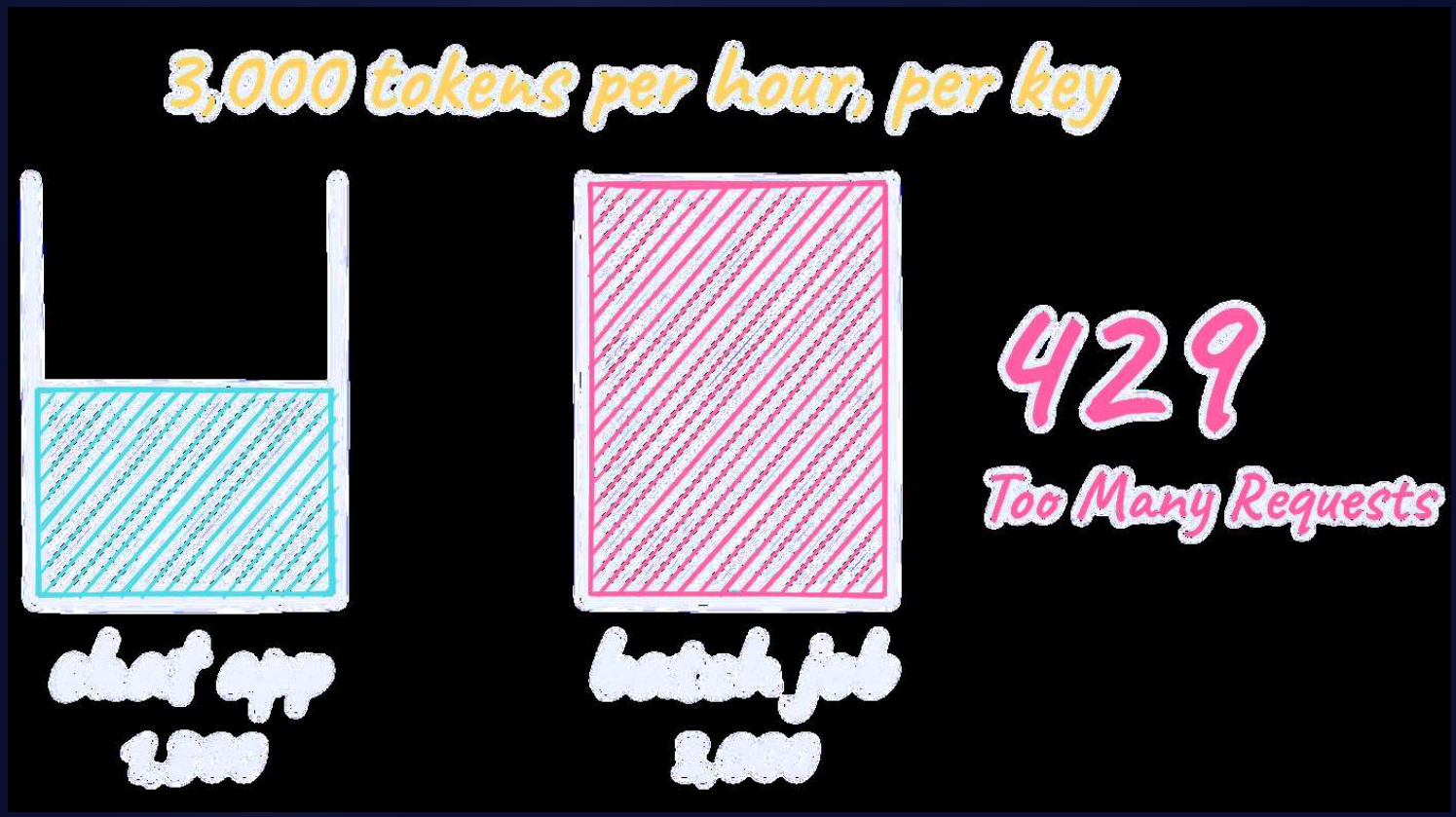
One endpoint for every model



One key per app

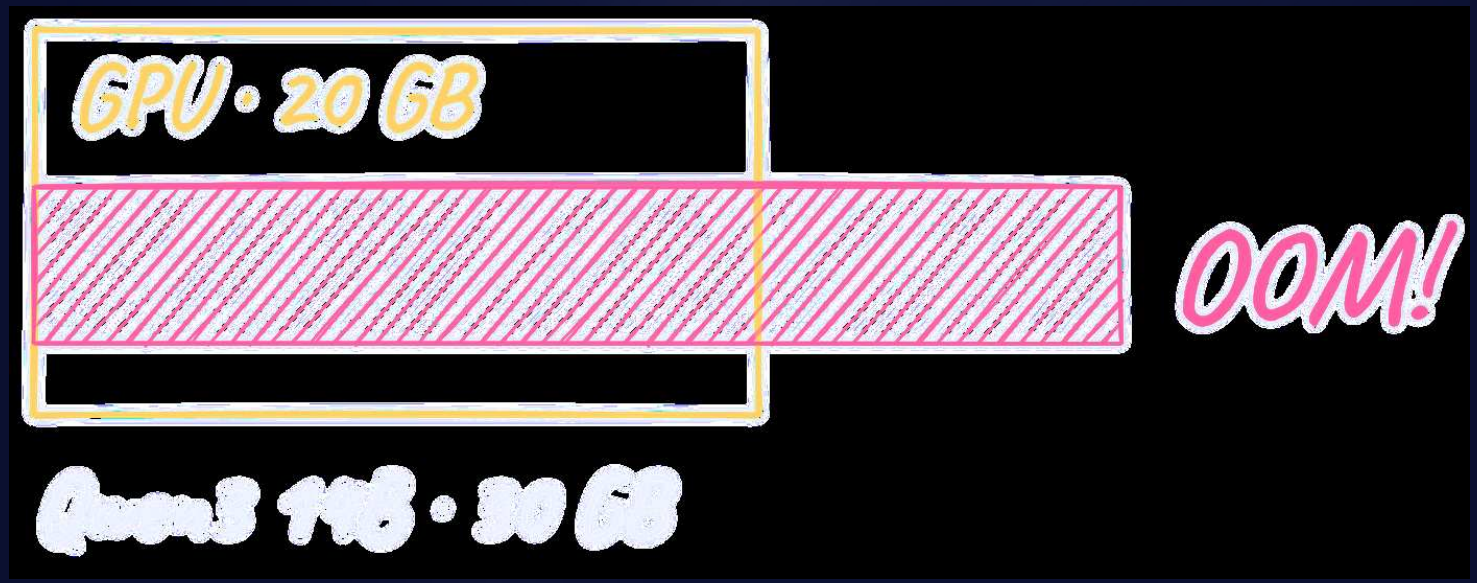


Count tokens, not requests

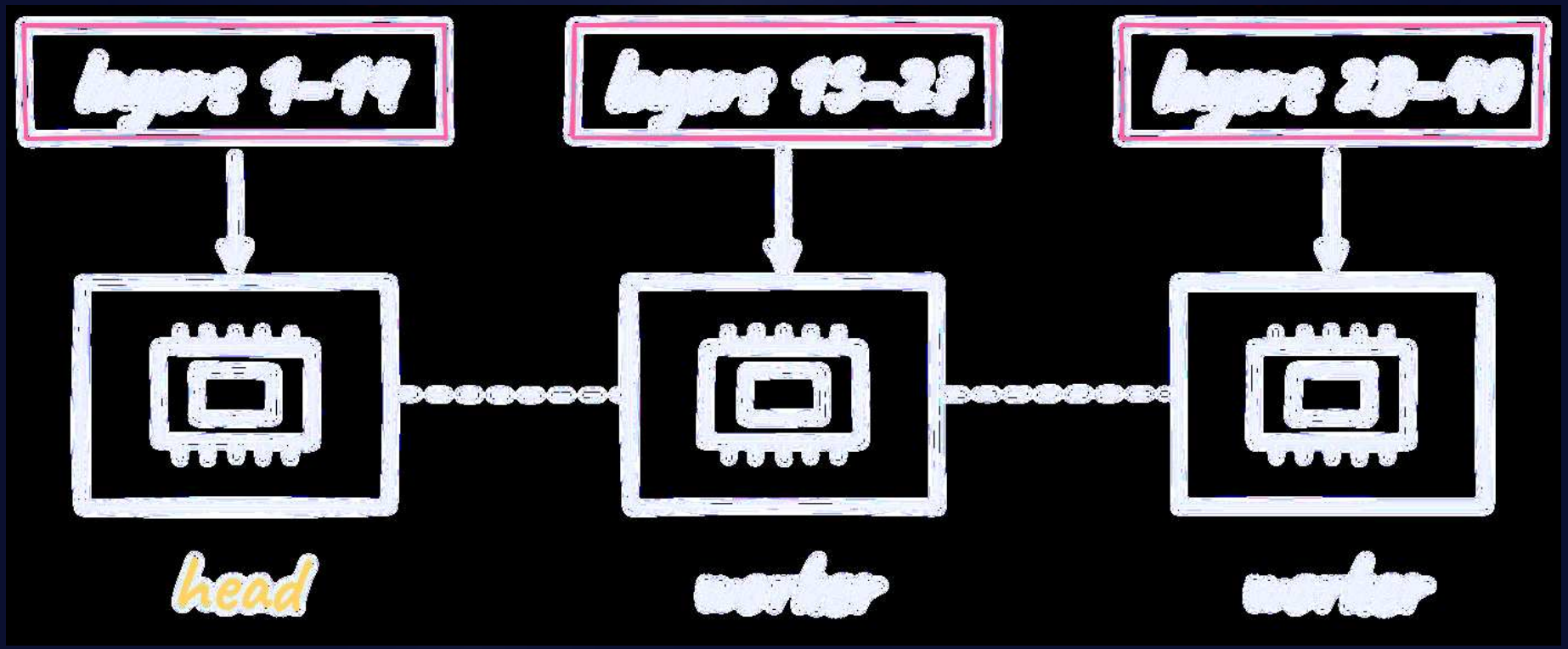



Month 2
Someone wants a bigger model

It doesn't fit

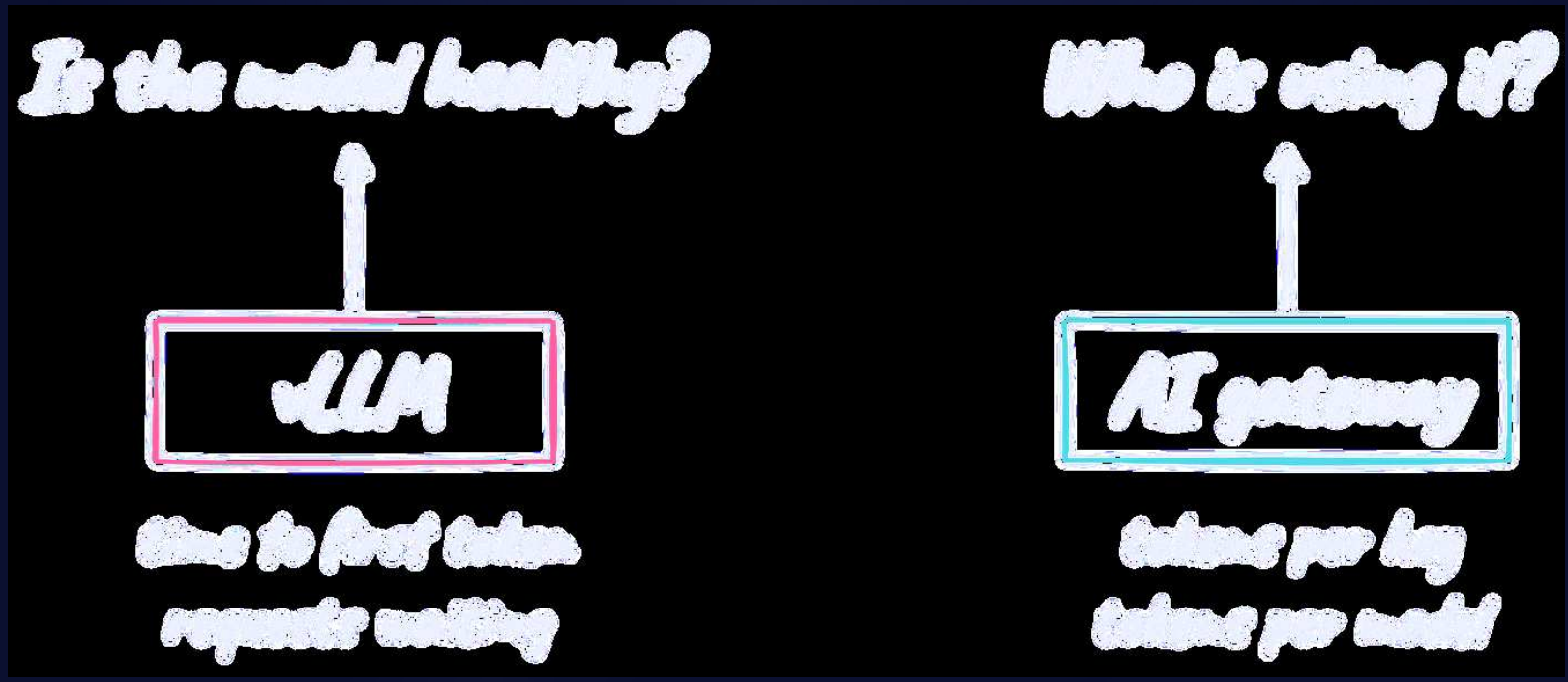


Split it across nodes

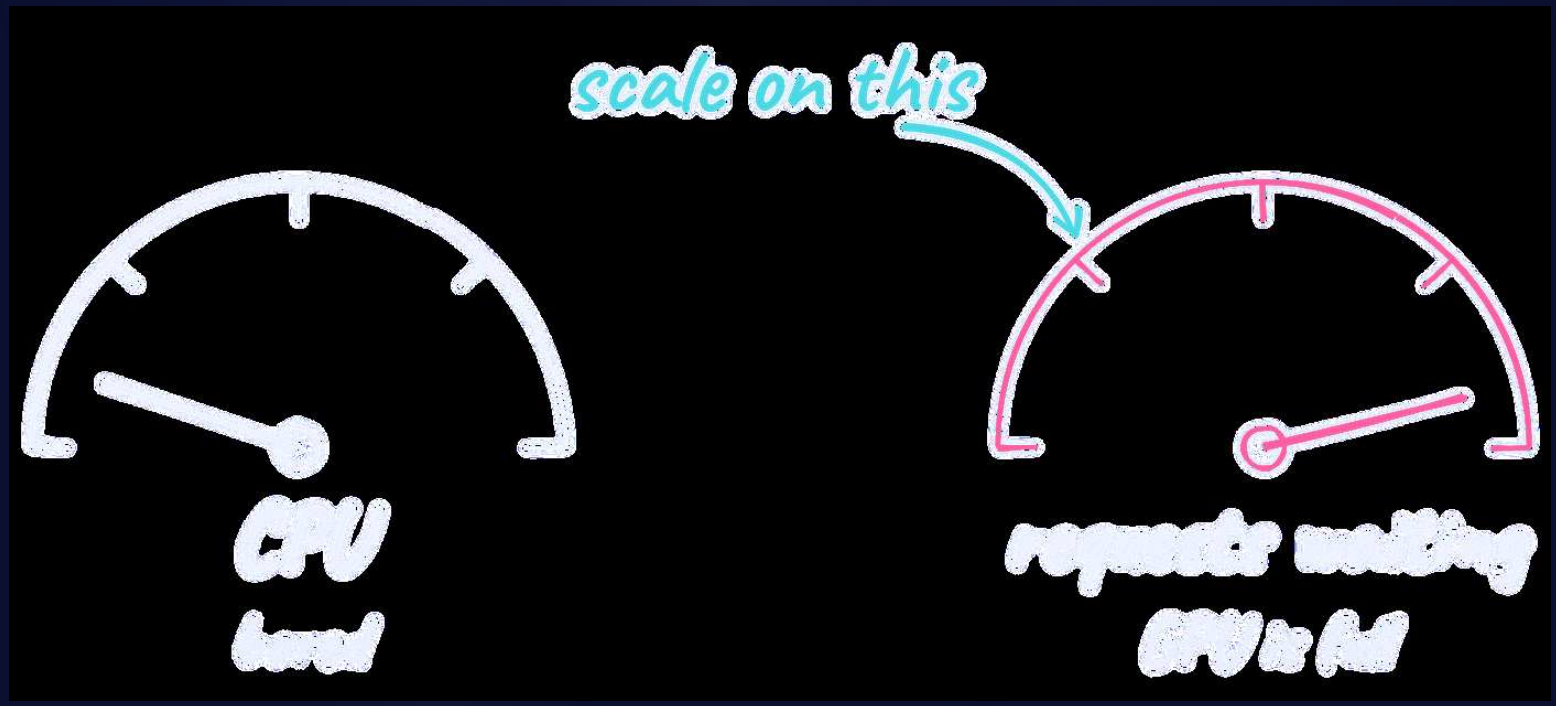



Month 3
Is it working? Who's paying?

Two questions



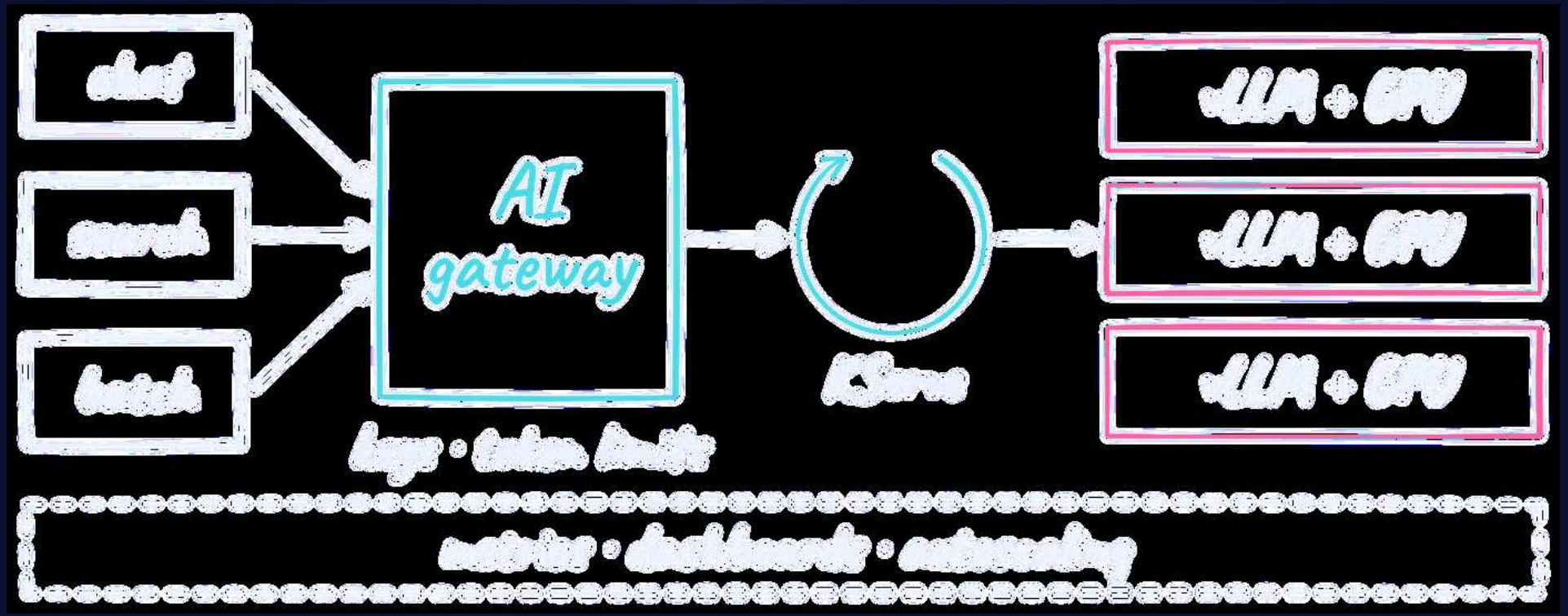
CPU % is a lie



A new replica is a 30 GB download



Look at what we just built



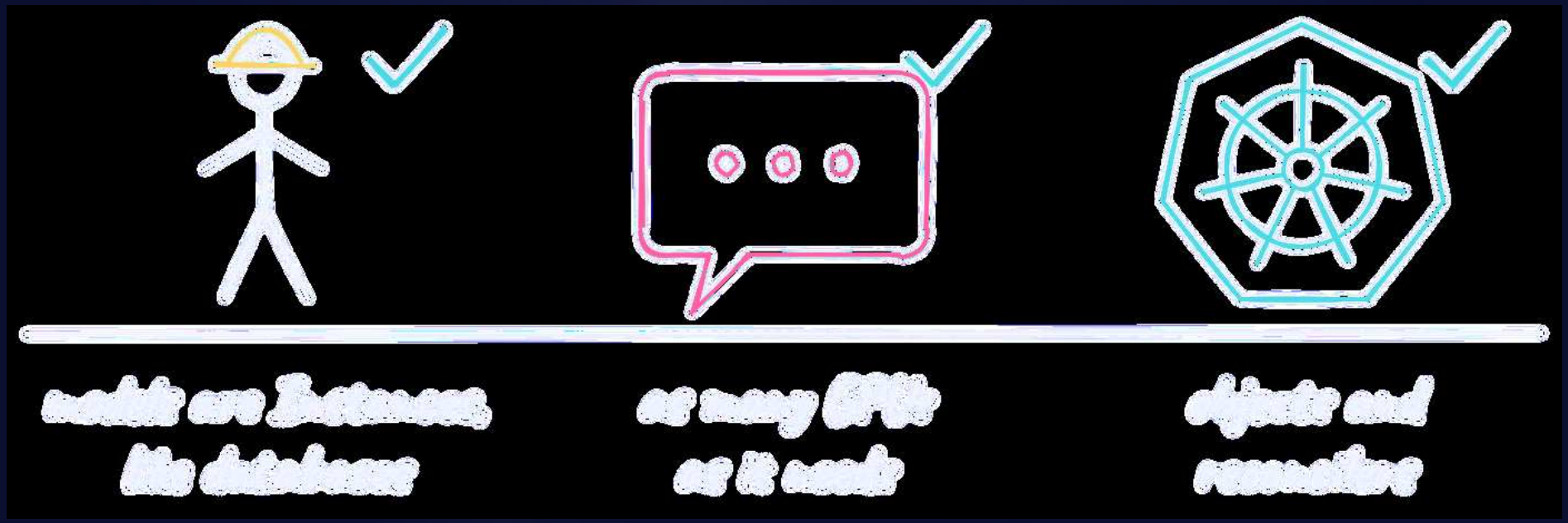
We've built this before



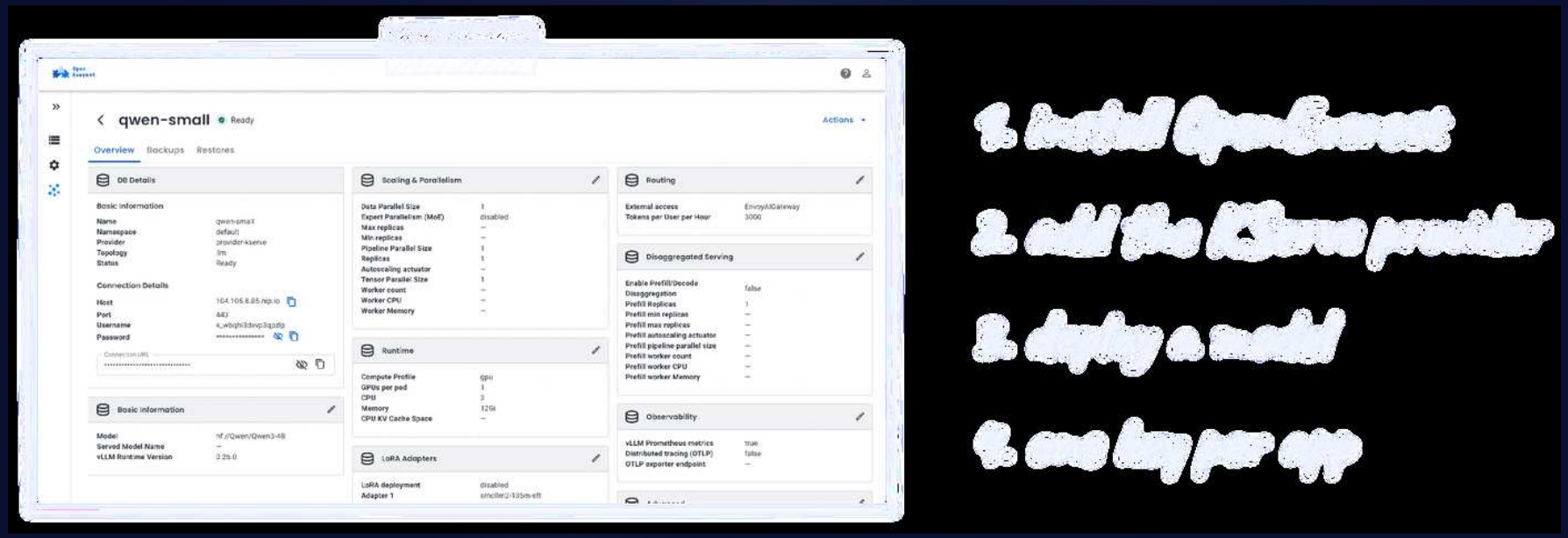
A model is just another Instance



Everyone got their order



Try it on your cluster



Thank you

